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Low acoustic magnetic mouse scroll wheel

Abstract

An information handling system peripheral mouse accepts scroll inputs at a scroll wheel extending from the upper surface of the mouse. The scroll wheel rotates about an axis and has a geared wheel core with peaks and valleys that rotate past a magnet, such as a Halbach magnet. The geared wheel core interacts with a magnetic field of the Halbach magnet so that magnetic flux resistance to rotation varies based upon the distance between the peaks and valleys to the magnetic field. Measuring changes in current at the geared wheel core related to changes in the magnetic field as the scroll wheel rotates provides an indication of wheel rotation, such as by spikes of current as the peaks pass the Halbach magnet.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Field of the Invention

(1) The present invention relates in general to the field of information handling system keyboards, and more particularly to an information handling system low acoustic magnetic mouse scroll wheel.

Description of the Related Art

(2) As the value and use of information continues to increase, individuals and businesses seek additional ways to process and store information. One option available to users is information handling systems. An information handling system generally processes, compiles, stores, and/or communicates information or data for business, personal, or other purposes thereby allowing users to take advantage of the value of the information. Because technology and information handling needs and requirements vary between different users or applications, information handling systems

may also vary regarding what information is handled, how the information is handled, how much information is processed, stored, or communicated, and how quickly and efficiently the information may be processed, stored, or communicated. The variations in information handling systems allow for information handling systems to be general or configured for a specific user or specific use such as financial transaction processing, airline reservations, enterprise data storage, or global communications. In addition, information handling systems may include a variety of hardware and software components that may be configured to process, store, and communicate information and may include one or more computer systems, data storage systems, and networking systems.

(3) Information handling systems integrate processing components into a housing that cooperate to process information communicated with an end user through input/output (I/O) devices, such as a keyboard, mouse and display. Desktop information handling systems have a stationary housing that typically communicates with a peripheral display, keyboard and mouse through a cable or wireless interface. Portable information handling systems have a portable housing that typically integrates a display, keyboard, touchpad and a power source to support mobile operations. Portable information handling systems allow end users to carry a system between meetings, during travel, and between home and office locations so that an end user has access to processing capabilities while mobile. Convertible configurations typically include multiple separate housing portions that couple to each other so that the system converts between closed and open positions. For example, a main housing portion integrates processing components and a keyboard and rotationally couples with hinges to a lid housing portion that integrates a display. In clamshell configuration, the lid housing portion rotates approximately ninety degrees to a raised position above the main housing portion so that an end user can type inputs while viewing the display. After usage, convertible information handling systems rotate the lid housing portion over the main housing portion to protect the keyboard and display, thus reducing the system footprint for improved storage and mobility.

(4) One difficulty that can arise with input devices is that end user interactions create audible noise that can be distracting to an end user or those around the end user. For example, when a keyboard key is pressed and then released the key is biased upward to a neutral position against a stop. Typically the upward bias of the key is substantial so that the key is quickly available for another input after the key is released. In plunger type keys a plastic hook of the key engages with the keyboard in the upper position to stop the key movement. The hook striking the keyboard tends to produce a clacking noise. Another example is the spacebar of the keyboard which tends to have a metal balancing bar to prevent tilting of the spacebar when pressed down at only one end. The metal balancing bar tends to rattle during movement of the spacebar. In many instances, the area under the keys is an empty space to allow for key movement. This area acts like an echo chamber that amplifies typing noise through partial empty volumetric air in the keyboard chassis. This area can also act as a liquid trap that collects and holds liquid spilled on the upper surface of the keyboard. In some instances, key noise is generated when the key completes an input, such as touching a sensor or reaching an end of downward key travel. For instance, mechanical spring type keys tend to bias upwards in response to metallic spring interactions that create audible noise on contact and that can degrade over time.

(5) Mouse input devices also typically generate audible noise in response to end user interactions. The audible noises may result from mouse button pushes similar to the key presses of a keyboard and from scroll wheel inputs. For example, a typical mouse scroll wheel has tactile feedback that opposes end user rotation and clicks when rotation takes place. For instance, a spring member extends to engage with gears of a wheel coupled to the scroll wheel so that a click occurs as each gear clicks by. Other arrangements include dimples formed in wheel that rotates with the scroll wheel and engages a spring member as the wheel rotates. In addition to generating audible clicks, these types of mechanical haptic feedback systems typically do not adjust the force applied to resist scroll wheel rotation.

(6) Another difficulty that arises with peripheral devices is that the devices often include both a

wireless and a cable interface to the information handling system. The cable interface is typically a USB cable that couples to a port of the peripheral device. USB offers both the exchange of information between the peripheral and information handling system and also the exchange of power so that a battery of the peripheral can charge when the cable is coupled in place. The transition to Type C USB cables have resulted in low profile ports at peripheral devices that are sometimes difficult to reinforce so that strain placed on the cable and port during use can result in damage to the port and associated peripheral device electronic components. Further, the small size of the cable and port can make connecting and disconnecting the cable to the port difficult for an end user.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(7) Therefore, a need has arisen for a system and method which dampens undesired acoustics associated with peripheral operations.

(8) Another need has arisen for a system and method that reduces the risk of damage to a peripheral when interfaced with a cable.

(9) In accordance with the present invention, a system and method are provided which substantially reduce the disadvantages and problems associated with previous methods and systems to accept inputs at a peripheral device with dampened acoustics. A further system and method are provided to manage cables coupled to peripheral devices so as to minimize risk of damage to the peripheral device.

(10) More specifically, an information handling system processes information with a processor that executes instructions in cooperation with a memory that stores the instructions and information. Peripheral devices interface with the processor, such as through a wireless interface or a cable interface, to provide inputs, such as keyboard key press input values and mouse scroll commands. Various techniques are applied to reduce undesired acoustics generated by peripheral device inputs. In one example embodiment, a fluid reservoir is positioned between a key cap and keyboard frame where impacts occur, such as the raised position of a key cap where an extension of the key cap hits a stop of the frame. In another example embodiment, magnets and dampeners are interfaced with a spacebar key cap to reduce rattle of a metal balancing bar that maintains the spacebar key cap level through an input press and release. An audible dampener is placed on the keyboard between keys to fill frame cavities that can cause key echoes, such as a silicon sheet placed over the keyboard membrane. A mouse scroll wheel has a MR fluid captured in a chamber with spaced blades so that rotation of the scroll wheel near a magnet stiffens the MR fluid to generate resistance at the blades and mimic scroll wheel clicks. In an alternative embodiment, a similar haptic feedback is created with a ferromagnetic geared wheel that rotates past a magnet to cycle between high and low magnetic forces. A cable couples to a port in a peripheral device having the port mounted on a receptacle circuit board that has freedom to move and thereby avoid excessive torsional forces. A sleeve made of rubberized material fits around the port and couples to the peripheral chassis to keep the port aligned with a chassis opening that accepts the cable. In another embodiment, a dongle fully inserts in the port to prevent application of excess torsional force and is pushed out with a magnetic toggle switch.

(11) The present invention provides a number of important technical advantages. One example of an important technical advantage is that an information handling system operates with peripheral devices that have undesired audible sounds dampened to reduce distractions to an end user. In one example embodiment, extraneous noise associated with space bar rattle was reduced by 12 db. The acoustic reduction techniques introduce minimal complexity and cost to achieve dampened sounds and higher quality peripheral devices.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The present invention may be better understood, and its numerous objects, features and advantages made apparent to those skilled in the art by referencing the accompanying drawings. The use of the same reference number throughout the several figures designates a like or similar element.
- (2) FIG. 1 depicts a desktop information handling system and portable information handling system configured to interface with a peripheral display, peripheral keyboard and peripheral mouse;
- (3) FIG. 2 depicts an upper perspective sectional view of a peripheral keyboard to illustrate the key cap vertical travel within a keyboard frame;
- (4) FIG. 3 depicts a side sectional view of a key cap in a raised position with audible sound associated with contact of the extension and stop dampened by a fluid reservoir;
- (5) FIG. 4 depicts an upper perspective view of a key cap having an example embodiment of a fluid reservoir at a key cap extension;
- (6) FIG. 5 depicts a top view of a peripheral keyboard with plural keys of different sizes;
- (7) FIGS. 6, 6A, 6B, 6C and 6D depict a space bar key cap maintained in a level orientation when depressed and returned to the raised position by a metal balancing bar having audible sounds damped with magnets;
- (8) FIG. 7 depicts a top view of the keyboard spacebar key cap area with the spacebar key cap removed;
- (9) FIGS. 8, 8A and 8B depict a bottom view of the spacebar key cap having an example embodiment of an alternative arrangement of magnets to manage metal balancing bar rattle;
- (10) FIGS. 9, 9A, 9B and 9C depict a bottom view of the spacebar key cap having another example embodiment for managing space bar rattle;
- (11) FIG. 10 depicts an exploded perspective view of a peripheral keyboard with an example embodiment having a noise dampener layer that diverts spilled liquids to a trench drain;
- (12) FIG. 11 depicts a side sectional view of a keyboard having an audible dampener disposed in the frame cavities between the key caps to dampen sounds that tend to echo out from the frame cavities;
- (13) FIG. 12 depicts an upper perspective view of the keyboard having the audible dampener disposed over the membrane to illustrate a secondary function of the audible dampener as protecting against liquid spills;
- (14) FIG. 13 depicts a side sectional view of the keyboard having a drain opening configured to remove liquid from the trench drain;
- (15) FIG. 14 depicts a top perspective view of a keyboard having an alternative embodiment of a key input detection sensor associated with magnetic key cap upward bias;
- (16) FIGS. 15 and 15A, a sectional view of mechanical key input switch depict an arrangement of magnets that biases the key cap to a raised position and detects a depressed position when the key cap is pressed;
- (17) FIGS. 16 and 16A depict a sectional view of the mechanical input key input switch with an arrangement of magnets in a depressed position that completes the input circuit and sends a signal through electrical leads;
- (18) FIG. 17 depicts a side perspective view of a mouse having a scroll wheel with a low acoustic haptic response;
- (19) FIG. 18 depicts an exploded perspective view of the scroll wheel having an example configuration of an MR fluid chamber with blades to generate a haptic response in resistance to scroll wheel rotation;
- (20) FIGS. 19A, 19B and 19C depict various configurations of magnetic flux and MR fluid magnetic particle composition to generate various haptic responses to scroll wheel rotation;
- (21) FIGS. 20, 20A, 20B, 20C and 20D depict a mouse having a scroll wheel example of a

magnetic based configuration to generate a haptic response in resistance to scroll wheel rotation;

(22) FIG. 21 depicts a side view of the geared wheel disposed proximate a magnet with a graph illustrating how magnetic flux changes in response to gear proximity with magnet as geared wheel rotates;

(23) FIG. 22 depicts a side sectional view of a mouse having a cable connection arrangement with enhanced resistance to internal breakage;

(24) FIG. 23 depicts a detailed view of the mouse having a cable connection arrangement with enhanced resistance to internal breakage;

(25) FIG. 24 depicts an upper perspective sectional view of the mouse cable connection arrangement with enhanced resistance to breakage;

(26) FIG. 25 depicts a lower perspective sectional view of the mouse cable connection arrangement with enhanced resistance to breakage;

(27) FIGS. 26 and 26A depict a magnetic toggle switch configured to remove a wireless dongle from a mouse cable port;

(28) FIGS. 27 and 27A depict a magnetic toggle switch activated to remove a wireless dongle from a mouse cable port; and

(29) FIGS. 28A, 28B, 28C and 28D depict a magnetic toggle switch configured to complete a circuit to indicate switch position.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(30) Information peripheral devices, such as a keyboard and mouse, accept inputs with reduced acoustical noise. For purposes of this disclosure, an information handling system may include any instrumentality or aggregate of instrumentalities operable to compute, classify, process, transmit, receive, retrieve, originate, switch, store, display, manifest, detect, record, reproduce, handle, or utilize any form of information, intelligence, or data for business, scientific, control, or other purposes. For example, an information handling system may be a personal computer, a network storage device, or any other suitable device and may vary in size, shape, performance, functionality, and price. The information handling system may include random access memory (RAM), one or more processing resources such as a central processing unit (CPU) or hardware or software control logic, ROM, and/or other types of nonvolatile memory. Additional components of the information handling system may include one or more disk drives, one or more network ports for communicating with external devices as well as various input and output (I/O) devices, such as a keyboard, a mouse, and a video display. The information handling system may also include one or more buses operable to transmit communications between the various hardware components.

(31) Referring now to FIG. 1, a desktop information handling system **10** and portable information handling system **32** are configured to interface with a peripheral display **30**, peripheral keyboard **40** and peripheral mouse **46**. In the example embodiment, desktop information handling system **10** processes information with processing components disposed in a stationary housing **12**. A central processing unit (CPU) **14** executes instructions that process information in cooperation with a random access memory (RAM) **16** that stores the instructions and information. For example, an operating system and application stored in persistent storage of a solid state drive (SSD) **18** are retrieved to RAM **16** by pre-boot instructions executing on an embedded controller **22** to bring the system to an operational state. A graphics processing unit (GPU) **20** further processes information to generate visual images defined by pixel values that are communicated through Universal Serial Bus (USB) hub **26** through a Type C display cable **28** for presentation at peripheral display **30**. A wireless network interface controller (WNIC) **24** supports wireless communication of signals, such as through WIFI and/or BLUETOOTH. Although the example embodiment of information handling system **10** depicts one example configuration of processing components that cooperate to process information, alternative embodiments may process information with alternative arrangements of processing components. For instance, portable information handling system **32** has a similar arrangement of processing components in a portable housing that presents visual images

at an integrated display **34** and that accepts inputs with an integrated keyboard **36** and integrated touchpad **38**.

(32) Both desktop information handling system **10** and portable information handling system **32** interact with end users through peripheral input/output (I/O) devices. In the example embodiment, a peripheral display **30** is an output device that presents visual images based upon information communicated through a display cable **28** and/or wireless communication by WNIC **24**. In the example embodiment, peripheral keyboard **40** and peripheral mouse **46** are input devices that accept end user inputs for communication to CPU **14**, such as through a cable or wireless interface managed by embedded controller **22**. Peripheral keyboard **40** has plural key caps **42** that press down to accept input values, such as those defined by a QWERTY keyboard. Key caps **42** are guided between a raised and depressed position with a keyboard frame **44** supporting each key cap in a travel range and aligned to contact a sensor under each key cap. Each key cap includes a biasing device that raises the key cap to the raised position after an end user input. Peripheral mouse **46** includes a position sensor that tracks mouse movement and translates the mouse movement to a cursor movement for presentation at the display. Peripheral mouse **46** includes buttons **48** that press down to accept end user inputs and a scroll wheel **50** that rotates to command a scroll of displayed information. In various embodiments, peripheral keyboard **40** and peripheral mouse **46** may have different configurations to accept key press inputs and position reporting. In one embodiment, the improvements to peripheral keyboard **40** may also be applied to improve integrated keyboard **36** of portable information handling system **32**.

(33) Referring now to FIG. 2, an upper perspective sectional view of a peripheral keyboard **40** depicts key cap **42** vertical travel within a keyboard frame **44**. Key cap **42** engages with frame **44** at a vertical member **56** that extends from the bottom surface of key cap **42** into frame **44**. The raised position of key cap **42** vertical travel is defined by an extension **58** from vertical member **56** towards frame **44** and against a stop **60** having a lower side surface that meets against the upper surface of extension **58**. A rubber dome **52** presses up against a central area of the bottom side of key cap **42** to bias key cap **42** to the raised position. When an end user presses down on key cap **42** to overcome the bias of rubber dome **52**, the central bottom portion of key cap **42** contacts an input switch sensor **54** that detects the key input, such as a pressure switch disposed in a conventional membrane **62** having a key input matrix to report the key input values associated with the key cap to an embedded controller. A frame cavity **64** is defined by the frame between each key cap as an empty space at the periphery around the key cap. During normal operation, audible sound is generated when a key cap is released from an input, extension **58** contacts stop **60** at the raised position. This audible sound can be amplified within frame cavity **64**.

(34) Referring now to FIG. 3, a side sectional view depicts a key cap **42** in a raised position with audible sound associated with contact of the extension **58** and stop **60** dampened by a fluid reservoir **66**. As described above, the vertical travel range of key cap **42** is defined at a raised position by engagement of stop **60** and extension **58** and at the bottom position by impact of rubber dome **52** inner member against the input sensor **54** of membrane **62**. Fluid reservoir **66** couples to key cap **42** at the upper side of extension **58** to dampen audible noise created when key cap **42** biases upward against stop **60**. In the example embodiment, a lubrication oil **68** is injected to the travel region of frame **44** to further dampen the noise and also reduce resistance associated with key travel within the vertical travel channel defined by frame **44** for each key. In an alternative embodiment, lubrication oil **68** may also be stored in a reservoir positioned at the bottom side of stop **60** to dampen contact against extension **58**. In one embodiment, a fluid reservoir is placed on both extension **58** and stop **60** and aligned to contact in the raised position to reduce noise created when key cap **42** gets to the raised position.

(35) Referring now to FIG. 4, an upper perspective view of a key cap **42** illustrates an example embodiment of a fluid reservoir at a key cap extension **58**. Fluid reservoir **66** has an outer membrane **70**, such as an elastic plastic, that encloses a fluid **72**. Membrane **70** couples in place at

extension **58** with an adhesive, such as in a cavity formed to accept the membrane shape. Fluid **72** is an oil and or grease fluid that encloses in membrane **70** to absorb a physical contact against a frame stop and dampen noise associated with contact against the frame stop by extension **58**. As an example, fluid **72** is an oil, such as a silencer oil having a grease composition, available from FUMIO at www.fumio.com.tw. In alternative embodiments, other types of fluids may be used, and a membrane to enclose the fluid may be used at both the extension and the stop to further dampen noise associated with key cap contact. Although the noise reduction techniques described herein are in the context of a peripheral keyboard, they may also be used within an integrated keyboard of a portable information handling system.

(36) Referring now to FIG. 5, a top view depicts a peripheral keyboard **40** with plural key caps **42** of different sizes. In addition to QWERTY key caps that each have a letter or number, a larger space bar **74** has a length of approximately 6 letter key caps, a shift key cap **76** has a length of three letter key caps and an enter key cap **78** has a length of approximately two key caps. Each of these key caps has a similar vertical travel as a letter/number key cap but can have some difficulty maintaining a level movement across the length of the key when depressed and raised. Additional structure can help to ensure level vertical movement of the key cap but tends to increase the audible noise associated with key presses and key return to the raised position. In the example of space bar **74**, a metal balancing bar coupled to the keyboard frame and the key cap maintain the space bar level during vertical travel and prevent tilting when pressed at the ends, however, the metal balancing bar can introduce rattling noise during spacebar movement.

(37) Referring now to FIGS. 6, 6A, 6B, 6C and 6D, a space bar key cap **74** is maintained in a level orientation when depressed and returned to the raised position by a metal balancing bar **80** having audible sounds damped with magnets. FIG. 6 depicts spacebar key **74** from a bottom side showing the position of metal balancing bar **80**, spacebar magnets **84** that travel vertically with the spacebar keycap and base magnets **86** that couple the keyboard frame to minimize metal balancing bar **80** rattle at a pivot axis. FIG. 6A depicts a sectional view AA from FIG. 6 with spacebar key cap **74** in a raised position having spacebar magnet **84** magnetically attracting metal balancing bar **80** to reduce rattling noise. The opposing ends of metal balancing bar **80** remain at a similar height to keep the spacebar key cap level through vertical travel, and both ends have an associated spacebar magnet **84** to keep the ferromagnetic material of metal balancing bar **80** against the spacebar keycap through motion to eliminate rattle of the metal against the spacebar plastic surface. FIG. 6B depicts a sectional view AA from FIG. 6 with spacebar key cap **74** in a lowered position having spacebar magnet **84** magnetically attracting metal balancing bar **80** to prevent rattle or other noise. Spacebar key cap **74** travels in a vertical channel defined by frame **44** with metal balancing bar **80** rotating to a substantially parallel orientation relative to frame **44**. FIG. 6C depicts a sectional view BB from FIG. 6 with spacebar key cap **74** in a raised position having base magnet **86** positioned to attract metal balancing bar **80** towards the bottom surface of frame **44**. FIG. 6D depicts a sectional view BB from FIG. 6 with spacebar key cap **74** in a lowered position having base magnet **86** positioned to attract metal balancing bar **80** towards the bottom surface of frame **20**. By maintaining magnetic attraction with base magnet **86** to metal balancing bar **80** during rotation, the axis of metal balancing bar **80** remains flat against the base of frame **44** to reduce rattle noise when the tips move vertically against the spacebar key cap.

(38) Referring now to FIG. 7, a top view depicts the keyboard spacebar key cap area with the spacebar key cap removed. Metal balancing bar **80** clips into positions with clips **88** that couple to frame **44**. An input switch **54** at a central location detects presses of the spacebar key cap against the input membrane to report inputs. Dual rubber domes **52** at each side of the spacebar key cap bias the key cap upwards and away from the bottom surface of frame **44**. Base magnets **86** magnetically attract metal balancing bar **80** towards frame **44** to prevent rattle against the frame and spacebar magnets **84** attract the opposing ends of metal balancing bar **80** against the spacebar key cap to prevent rattle at the contact location of the spacebar key cap. In one example

embodiment, including magnets to reduce rattle of the balance bar decreases noise associated with movement of the spacebar by substantially 12 dB.

(39) Referring now to FIGS. **8**, **8A** and **8B**, an example embodiment depicts a bottom view of the spacebar key cap **74** having an alternative arrangement of magnets to manage metal balancing bar **80** rattle. In the example embodiment, a side clip **90** coupled to spacebar key cap **74** at each opposing end of metal balancing bar **80** presses against the ends of metal balancing bar **80** to reduce rattle, such as by including a cushion that reduces acoustic noise. A magnet **92** couples to the side of the clip to magnetically attract the metal balancing bar tip within the side clip **90** and thereby further reduce the rattle. FIG. **8A** depicts a side sectional view of spacebar key cap **74** with magnet **92** aligned to the metal balancing bar **80** tip through rotation between raised and lowered positions within frame **44**. FIG. **8B** depicts a detailed view of side clip **90** coupled to spacebar key cap **74** and configured to grasp the metal balancing bar tip with magnet **92** placed at the metal balancing bar tip end to reduce rattle. The side clip may be used in conjunction with other magnets, such as those depicted in FIGS. **6** and **7**, and also with cushions as described below with respect to FIG. **9**.

(40) Referring now to FIGS. **9**, **9A**, **9B** and **9C**, a bottom view of the spacebar key cap **74** depicts another example embodiment for managing space bar rattle. Metal balancing bar **80** couples at opposing ends to a rubber cushion **94**, such as a rubberized silicon material, that dampens vibrations to reduce rattle acoustics. Rubber cushion **94** couples to spacebar key cap **74** with a retainer **96** extending from the bottom surface of the key cap. For instance, rubber cushion **94** couples with adhesive to retainer **96** formed as a plastic injection part. FIGS. **9A** and **9B** depict a sectional view AA as indicated by FIG. **9** of the spacebar key cap **74** in a raised position and depressed position respectively. As indicated by the side view of rubber cushion **94** in FIG. **9C**, a retainer **96** is formed in the rubber cushion that defines motion of the end of metal balancing bar **80** when spacebar key cap **74** travels between the raised and depressed positions. The cushioning of the metal balancing bar contact point with rubber cushion **94** within retainer **96** reduces vibration during movement resulting in reduced acoustic noise. As the key cap moves vertically within frame **44**, retainer **96** is shaped to maintain contact against metal balancing bar **80** so that vibrations are dampened. These various spacebar key cap acoustic management techniques as described above may be applied to an integrated keyboard of a portable information handling system and to key caps of smaller sizes than the space bar.

(41) Referring now to FIG. **10**, an exploded perspective view of a peripheral keyboard **40** depicts an example embodiment having a noise dampener layer that diverts spilled liquids to a trench drain. A top frame **100** and key caps **42** couple to a frame **44** to enclose a keyboard printed circuit board **102**, membrane **62** and an audible dampener **98** disposed over membrane **62**. Audible dampener **98** is, for instance, a silicon structure that fills voids between key caps **42** to dampen noise and echoes related to key cap actuations. In the example embodiment, audible dampener **98** is a solid sheet soft silicon rubber material having openings cut where rubber domes and input sensors are located so as not to interfere with key cap inputs. In an alternative embodiment, audible dampener **98** may be cut into small pieces that fill just the frame cavity between key caps.

(42) Referring now to FIG. **11**, a side sectional view depicts keyboard **40** having audible dampener **98** disposed in frame cavities **64** between key caps **42** to dampen sounds that tend to echo out from the frame cavities. When a key cap **42** depresses from the raised position to compress rubber dome **52** against membrane **62** having an input sensor **54**, the noise associated with the input is dampened outside the key cap **42** periphery by audible dampener **98**. Similarly, when key cap **42** is released to bias upwards to the raised position, noise created by the impact of the key cap extension against the frame stop is also dampened by audible dampener **98**. Empty air pockets within frame cavities **64** that tend to echo and amplify sound are filled with a silicon or similar material that dampens noise propagation, thereby reducing audible sounds associated with keyboard inputs.

(43) Referring now to FIG. **12**, an upper perspective view of the keyboard having audible

dampener **98** disposed over the membrane illustrates a secondary function of the audible dampener as protecting against liquid spills. When deployed and operational, the keyboard typically has taller feet at a rear side that raise the rear relative to the front side for improved typing. Printed circuit board **102** at a rear position is less likely to have exposure to water **104** in the event of a leak. Audible dampener **98** protects the separate underlying membrane from liquid damage by draining spilled water (or other fluid) downward and towards a trench drain **106** at the front side of the keyboard. In one example embodiment, the silicon or similar material selected for audible dampener **98** is selected to encourage surface tension of spilled water so that the water travels towards trench drain **106**. In another embodiment, the thickness of the audible dampener **98** is tapered towards the front and between rubber domes to help drain liquid towards trench drain **106**.

(44) Referring now to FIG. **13**, a side sectional view of keyboard **40** depicts a drain opening cap **108** configured to remove liquid **104** from trench drain **106**. In the example embodiment, keyboard **40** is elevated at a rear side so that gravity drains spilled fluid along audible dampener **98** towards drain trench **106**. Fluid that enters the keyboard tends to enter at a periphery of a key cap **42** and drain to audible dampener **98** where the fluid is directed towards trench drain **106**. When drain opening cap **108** is removed at trench drain **106**, liquid **104** is allowed to drain out of keyboard **40**. In the example embodiment, audible dampener **98** extends from the rear side to the rear side of the most front row of key caps **42** to define the space of the trench drain **106** where water can pool.

(45) Referring now to FIG. **14**, a top perspective view of keyboard **40** depicts an alternative embodiment of a key input detection sensor associated with magnetic key cap **42** upward bias. In the example embodiment, keyboard **40** has one key cap **42** removed to expose a mechanical key input switch **110** that detects key depressions as key inputs. Mechanical key input switch **110** in the example embodiment includes opposing magnets that provide an upward bias and that detect key depressions with minimal acoustic noise, as is described in greater depth below.

(46) Referring now to FIGS. **15** and **15A**, a sectional view of mechanical key input switch **110** depicts an arrangement of magnets that biases the key cap to a raised position and detects a depressed position when the key cap is pressed. A key cap couples to a plunger **112** captured between a top cover **114** and a bottom cover **116**. Electrical leads **118** extend from bottom cover **116** to couple to a circuit board and communicate when an input is detected. For instance, one of the electrical leads provides a current that communicates out the other electrical lead when the switch closes to complete a circuit. Plunger magnet **120** couples to the bottom surface of plunger **112** with an arrangement of north and south poles that match push up magnet **122**. A press down of plunger **112** brings like poles of plunger magnet **120** and push up magnet **122** in alignment resulting in an upward bias to a raised position. Push up magnet **122** is coupled to a rubberized base **124** that dampens sound and absorbs contact when made. In the raised position depicted by the sectional side view of FIG. **15A**, a repelling force of the same pole magnet alignment biases plunger **112** in a raised position and also pulls sliding contact magnet **126** to a raised position within a sound isolation chamber defined by top cover **114** and bottom cover **116**. In the raised position, sliding contact magnet **126** is distal electrical leads **118** so that the switch circuit is open to indicate a lack of an input from the key.

(47) Referring now to FIGS. **16** and **16A**, a sectional view of mechanical input key input switch **110** depicts an arrangement of magnets in a depressed position that completes the input circuit and sends a signal through electrical leads **118**. When sufficient force is pressed down on plunger **112**, the upward bias of push up magnet **122** and plunger magnet **120** is overcome to depress the key cap. Downward movement of plunger magnet **120** translates to sliding contact magnet **126** to bring sliding contact magnet in physical contact with electrical leads **118**, thus completing the circuit and signaling an input. When the press is released, pushup magnet **122** and plunger magnet **120** bias plunger **112** up to the raised position. The sliding contact magnet **126** and electrical leads **118** make contact in an isolated chamber **128** over rubber base **124** so that sounds are minimized and dampened. Sliding motion to bring spring ends of electrical leads **118** into contact with sliding

contact magnet **126** avoids a striking noise and striking action to reduce sound made at contact. Magnetic attraction and repelling forces used instead of mechanical springs and switches provides a consistent key input response that does not degrade over time.

(48) Referring now to FIG. **17**, a side perspective view depicts a mouse **46** having a scroll wheel **50** with a low acoustic haptic response. Scroll wheel **50** rotates about a shaft **134** and encloses magnetorheological (MR) fluid in a chamber having blades that create a haptic response to a rotation by an end user. A sliding magnet housing **130** couples plural magnets **132** of varying flux proximate the MR fluid to adjust the viscosity of the MR fluid for selectable haptic response. MR fluid consists of liquid oil with very fine micro magnetic particles suspending within the oil that change the viscosity of the oil when magnetic flux is applied, such as by three external magnets of varying heights and sizes. The magnetic flux creates a chain of particles within the fluid in the direction of the magnetic flux having increased viscoelastic characteristics as the flux increases. The interior of the chamber having the MR fluid includes spaced blades that resist rotation of the chamber in varying amounts based upon the size of the chain of magnetic particles within the fluid. The spaced blades create high and low resistance as the chamber rotates past the magnets to mimic the tactile feel offered by conventional mechanical scroll wheels. The amount of resistance can vary based upon the length of blades within the MR fluid chamber and the amount of magnetic flux placed by the MR fluid and chamber.

(49) Referring now to FIG. **18**, an exploded perspective view of scroll wheel **50** depicts an example configuration of an MR fluid chamber with blades to generate a haptic response in resistance to scroll wheel rotation. Shaft **134** couples to mouse structure to provide a rotational axis in cooperation with a rotation member **144** on an opposing side of the scroll wheel **50**. A rotation sensor to detect scroll wheel rotation may couple to shaft **134** or may be an optical sensor coupled to the mouse and directed at either side of the scroll wheel, or other types of rotation sensors. A core magnet **146** couples in a central location of shaft **134** to bias MR fluid particles towards a central location that reduces rotation resistance of the scroll wheel. An MR fluid seal **136** fits within a rubberized outer ring **140** and couples to a central wheel **142** to define a chamber **146** in which MR fluid is contained. Within chamber **146** at the inner circumference a set of evenly spaced blades **138** extend from the periphery inwards partially to the center position of shaft **134**. MR fluid seal **136** is located above sliding magnet housing **130** so that a selectable amount of magnetic flux is available from magnets **132** to adjust the amount of resistance applied against rotation of the scroll wheel when the blades **138** within chamber **146** interact with magnetic particles of the MR fluid. In an alternative embodiment, magnets **132** may include one or more electropermanent magnets that turn magnetic flux on and off in response to a command signal from the mouse MCU.

(50) Referring now to FIGS. **19A**, **19B** and **19C**, various configurations of magnetic flux and MR fluid magnetic particle composition are depicted to generate various haptic responses to scroll wheel rotation. FIG. **19A** illustrates that a south pole of magnet **132** in sliding magnet housing **130** aligns with a north pole of core magnet **146** to create a particle chain **148** between first and second blades **138** of the MR fluid chamber **136** to create resistance to rotation of scroll wheel **50** when an end user applies a rotational force at rubber outer ring **140**. FIG. **19B** depicts that rotation of blade **138** through particle chain **148** increases resistance leading to an end user who applies force to cause rotation to receive a haptic feedback that mimics a spring click. As blade **138** passes through particle chain **148**, resistance to rotation decreases so that a cycle of high and low rotational forces generates a haptic feedback for the amount of rotation of the scroll wheel. The resistance is adjustable by changing the length and width of the blades and the magnetic particle concentration in the MR fluid. FIG. **19C** depicts an example of a reduced resistance from a reduced concentration of magnetic particles due to the alignment of a smaller magnet with an increased distance to the scroll wheel. When sliding magnet housing **130** brings the magnets **132** out of alignment with core magnet **146**, then core magnet **146** tends to draw the magnetic particles away from blades **138** to allow the scroll wheel to freely rotate without a haptic response.

(51) Referring now to FIGS. 20, 20A, 20B, 20C and 20D, a mouse is depicted having a scroll wheel 50 as an example of a magnetic based configuration to generate a haptic response in resistance to scroll wheel rotation. In the example embodiment, scroll wheel 50 generates the haptic response with a geared wheel 150 of ferromagnetic material that rotates proximate a magnet so that magnetic flux changes with rotational orientation relative to the geared wheel teeth. A rotation sensor 152 couples to the scroll wheel to detect changes in rotational orientation that are reported as scroll commands. FIG. 20A depicts a perspective view of scroll wheel 50 with geared wheel 150 coupled to a central core wheel 164 that has an axle 160 extending to and rotationally coupling with a cradle 162. A rotation sensor couples to axle 160 on an opposite side of geared wheel 150. FIG. 20B depicts the orientation of magnet 132 relative to geared wheel 150 so that the magnetic flux varies as the gear proximity to the magnet changes distance between gear peaks and valleys. The amount of haptic feedback is adjusted by moving cradle 162 relative to the rotational axis of geared wheel or by changing the size of magnet 132. In one embodiment, magnet 132 is one or more electropermanent magnets that a controller can turn off so that the scroll wheel rotates without haptic response. FIG. 20C depicts a top view of the scroll wheel to illustrate axle 160 coupled into cradle 162 with geared wheel 150 configured to rotate and rotation sensor 152 configured to measure rotational orientation. In one embodiment, rotation sensor 152 is a Hall sensor that detects pulses in current related to movement of gear teeth past the magnet. FIG. 20D depicts a side view of the scroll wheel having rotation sensor 152 coupled to axle 160 and oriented to have an optical sensing element directed at wheel core 164 to detect rotation.

(52) Referring now to FIG. 21, a side view depicts geared wheel 150 disposed proximate a magnet 132 with a graph 158 illustrating how magnetic flux changes in response to gear proximity with magnet 132 as geared wheel 150 rotates. When a peak region 154 of geared wheel 150 passes by magnet 132, magnetic flux increases resulting in increased resistance to rotation. When a valley region 156 of geared wheel 150 passes by magnet 132, magnetic flux decreases resulting in decreased resistance to rotation so that a haptic effect is generated. The amount of haptic effect is configurable by the size of the peaks, depth of the valleys, size of the magnet, distance of the magnet to the geared wheel and type of ferromagnetic material from which the geared wheel is made. In one example embodiment, geared wheel 150 is made of a silicon steel material that has an enhanced magnetic interaction. As described above, during rotation the movement of geared wheel 150 relative to magnet 132 creates current spikes that a Hall sensor or a current detection device can monitor to detect rotational orientation changes. For example, spikes in current related to changes in magnetic fields may be sensed by a mouse microcontroller unit (MCU) that interfaces with the ferromagnetic material through an analog GPIO.

(53) Referring now to FIG. 22, a side sectional view of a mouse 46 depicts a cable connection arrangement having enhanced resistance to internal breakage. USB cable connections, particularly small-sized cable connections such as Type-C connections, can break internal components of a peripheral device when torsion forces are applied, such as with mouse peripheral ports. In the example embodiment, a chassis 170 of mouse 46 has a USB Type-C cable port 172 that accepts a USB Type-C cable connector 174. When torsional forces are applied at cable port 172 by cable connector 174, a small circuit board that mounts the USB Type-C port allows some movement dampened by a rubber sleeve to help reduce the risk of breakages that can cause mouse failure, such as solder breaks.

(54) Referring now to FIG. 23, a detailed view depicts the mouse 46 having a cable connection arrangement with enhanced resistance to internal breakage. In the example embodiment, cable connector 174 couples to cable port 172 that is affixed, such as with solder, to a free floating receptacle board 176. Receptacle board 176 is free to move vertically relative to chassis 170 and a main circuit board 182 of mouse 46. Receptacle board 176 interfaces with main board 182 through a flexible circuit cable connector 178 and a flexible circuit cable 180. A rubber sleeve 184 holds receptacle board 176 in place by fitting around cable port 172 and coupling to chassis 170. In one

example embodiment, soft foam may also be inserted around receptacle board **176** to protect receptacle board **176** from damage. In the example embodiment, a push down on cable connector **174** translates to receptacle board **176** as an upward movement while communication with main board **182** is maintained through the flexible cable. Rubber sleeve **184** couples to chassis **170**, such as with an adhesive, so that force applied to cable port **172** is absorbed by the rubber sleeve material without translating to the receptacle board, thereby avoiding damage to the receptacle board and the port affixed by solder to the receptacle board.

(55) Referring now to FIG. **24**, an upper perspective sectional view depicts the mouse **46** cable connection arrangement with enhanced resistance to breakage. Cable port connector **172** in the example embodiment is a Type-C connector that solders to receptacle board **176**, which floats free relative to main board **182**. Receptacle board **176** has a small surface area, such as substantially only the size of the cable port and flexible cable connector, so that a greater amount of movement is tolerable without impacting internal structures within chassis **170**. Cable port **172** inserts through rubber sleeve **184**, which couples to chassis **170**, such as with adhesive, and aligns cable port **172** with the opening of chassis **170** through which the cable connector inserts.

(56) Referring now to FIG. **25**, a lower perspective sectional view depicts the mouse cable connection arrangement with enhanced resistance to breakage. Receptacle board **176** couples to cable port **172** and interfaces through circuit board wirelines with flexible printed circuit cable **180** to communicate power and information through connector **178** to main board **182**. Rubber sleeve **184** couples to chassis **170** to absorb external forces applied by cable connector **174** and to maintain the cable opening of cable port **172** aligned to accept cable connector **174** through the chassis opening. Rubber sleeve **184** is, for instance, a rubberized injection molded plastic or a silicon rubber material that withstands applied forces without tearing and yields to move within constraints associated with the size of receptacle board **176** so that receptacle board **176** will not impact other internal structures. In one embodiment, rubber sleeve **184** and flexible printed circuit cable **180** are the only coupling locations of receptacle board **176** to mouse **46**. In one example embodiment, rubber sleeve **184** does not couple directly to receptacle board **176** but rather only indirectly by inserting around cable port **172**. Alternatively, adhesive on rubber sleeve **184** may also couple to receptacle board **176**, although this approach may transfer some stress to the receptacle board. In one embodiment, the inner circumference of rubber sleeve **184** may have adhesive to couple to the outer surface of cable port **172** to hold the assembly in alignment with the chassis opening when rubber sleeve **184** couples to chassis **170**. One advantage of the small size of receptacle board **176** is that substantially thicker circuit board material may be used for receptacle board **176** without impacting the thickness of main board **182**. For instance, receptacle board **176** may have twice the thickness of main board **182** for a more robust coupling of cable port **172**.

(57) Referring now to FIGS. **26** and **26A**, a magnetic toggle switch **200** is depicted configured to remove a wireless dongle **188** from a mouse **46** cable port. In the example embodiment, wireless dongle **188** has a USB Type-C connector that couples to a USB Type-C port of mouse **46** in a manner similar to the cable arrangement of FIG. **25**, such as with a receptacle circuit board. Wireless dongle **188** includes wireless radio circuitry to communicate through a wireless interface, such as a BLUETOOTH or similar wireless personal area network (WPAN) or a wireless local area network (WLAN). In order to minimize torsional forces that transfer from wireless dongle **188** to internal structure of mouse **46**, wireless dongle **188** fully inserts with the end of the dongle flush to the mouse chassis, as is depicted in FIG. **26**. Although a flush insertion limits the risk that torsional forces can damage internal chassis structure, the lack of any part of wireless dongle **188** extending from the chassis introduces difficulty for an end user to remove wireless dongle **188** from the mouse.

(58) The magnetic toggle switch **200** interacts with wireless dongle **188** to push wireless dongle **188** out of mouse **46** so that an end user can grasp and pull the wireless dongle free. The magnetic toggle switch **200** has a ferromagnetic housing **194** and first and second vertically stacked magnets

192 within housing **194**. An exposed lever **190** abuts against the end of the lower magnet **192** to push the lower magnet further into the mouse housing in order to command an ejection of wireless dongle **188**. As is illustrated by FIG. **26A**, both magnets **192** fit into housing **194** with the same magnetic pole orientation, resulting in the upper magnet north pole aligning with the lower magnet south pole in a laterally offset manner. When wireless dongle **188** inserts into the wireless cable port, the upper magnet **192** is pressed backwards, which interacts magnetically with the lower magnet to extend out and press against exposed lever **190** to press out to an installed position as shown.

(59) Referring now to FIGS. **27** and **27A**, a magnetic toggle switch **200** is depicted actuated to remove a wireless dongle **188** from a mouse cable port. When exposed lever **190** is pressed inward against the lower magnet **192**, the south poles align resulting in a rejection force pressing the upper magnet outward and against wireless dongle **188**. FIG. **27A** depicts the upper magnet motivated outward to push wireless dongle **188** out of mouse **46** so that an end user finger can grasp the dongle and pull it free. In one example embodiment, a lubricant, such as grease, disposed between the magnets **192** helps to move the magnets relative to each other. Alternatively, ball bearings or other friction reduction devices may be used to reduce resistance against the movement of the magnets in response to changes in the magnetic field. In another example embodiment, rather than having an exposed lever **190** the lower magnet **192** extends out to be pressed directly inward to eject the wireless dongle. In this regard, ferromagnetic housing **194** keeps the magnets in place within the housing by magnetic attraction.

(60) Referring now to FIGS. **28A**, **28B**, **28C** and **28D**, a magnetic toggle switch **200** is depicted configured to complete a circuit to indicate switch position. Ferromagnetic housing **194** maintains magnets **192** in the housing with a length of substantially the length of the magnets so that repelling force from like pole alignment will bias one of the magnets **192** out of housing **194** at all times. FIG. **28A** depicts the lower magnet extending out and the upper magnet pressed inward. FIG. **28B** depicts that the upper magnet presses to the rear side of housing **194** where it can move an internal part. FIG. **28C** depicts a sectional view of magnetic toggle switch **200** showing the alignment of opposite poles of the upper and lower magnets **192**. When lower magnet **192** is pressed inward to housing **194**, alignment of like poles within housing **194** will force the upper magnet out of housing **192** and keep the lower magnet within housing **194**. FIG. **28D** depicts an example embodiment in which magnetic toggle switch **200** is used to turn a current on and off by engaging the current through the magnets or otherwise completing a circuit. In one example embodiment, movement of the magnets relative to each other generates a current that is monitored for an indication of switch actuation.

(61) Although the present invention has been described in detail, it should be understood that various changes, substitutions and alterations can be made hereto without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention as defined by the appended claims.

Claims

1. An information handling system comprising: a housing; a processor disposed in the housing and operable to execute instruction to process information; a memory disposed in the housing and interfaced with the processor, the memory operable to store the information and instructions; a mouse interfaced with the processor, the mouse having a scroll wheel configured to rotate about an axis, the scroll wheel having a gear wheel with extensions about an outer perimeter that define peaks and valleys relative to a magnet coupled external the outer perimeter and proximate the scroll wheel, the gear wheel rotating about the axis, the interaction of the peaks and valleys with the magnet creating haptic feedback to wheel rotation, the mouse further having a rotation sensor aligned to detect scroll wheel rotation as a scroll input, the rotation sensor including at least a microcontroller having a general purpose input/output (GPIO) interfaced with the gear wheel to

- measure changes in current related to rotation of the gear wheel proximate the magnet.
2. The information handling system of claim 1 wherein the gear wheel comprises silicon steel.
 3. The information handling system of claim 1 wherein the magnet comprises a Halbach magnet.
 4. The information handling system of claim 1 wherein the rotation sensor comprises an optical sensor directed at the gear wheel.
 5. The information handling system of claim 1 wherein the magnet comprises an electropermanent magnet having an off and an on state.
 6. The information handling system of claim 1 further comprising a cradle that couples to the scroll wheel at a rotational axis and to a chassis of the mouse.
 7. The information handling system of claim 6 wherein the magnet couples to the cradle aligned proximate the gear wheel.
 8. The information handling system of claim 7 wherein the rotation sensor couples to the cradle on an opposite side of the scroll wheel to the gear wheel and magnet.
 9. A method for managing haptic feedback of an information handling system mouse scroll wheel, the method comprising: coupling a gear wheel to the scroll wheel, the gear wheel having plural gears disposed at an outer perimeter; resisting rotation of the scroll wheel with a magnet aligned external to the gear wheel and having varying magnet attraction as peaks and valleys of the gear wheel gears rotate past the magnet; and detecting scroll wheel rotation with a rotation sensor to report as a scroll input, the rotation sensor including a processing resource having a general purpose input/output (GPIO) interfaced with the gear wheel to measure analog current changes resulting from rotation of the gear wheel relative to the magnet.
 10. The method of claim 9 wherein the gear wheel comprises silicon steel.
 11. The method of claim 9 wherein the magnet comprises a Halbach magnet.
 12. The method of claim 9 wherein the rotation sensor comprises an optical sensor directed towards the scroll wheel.
 13. The method of claim 9 wherein the magnet comprises an electropermanent magnet having an on and off state.
 14. A mouse comprising: a chassis; a processing resource having a GPIO operable to measure analog current; a scroll wheel rotating about a rotation axis; a gear wheel of ferromagnetic material coupled to rotate with the scroll wheel and interfaced with the general purpose input/output (GPIO), the gear wheel having plural gears extending out from an outer perimeter; and a magnet external to the gear wheel and directed at the gear wheel to create haptic feedback through interactions with peaks and valleys of the gear wheel as the gear wheel rotates the plural gears past the magnet; wherein the processing resource detects rotation of the scroll wheel to report as scroll inputs by measuring changes in current at the gear wheel.
 15. The mouse of claim 14 wherein the gear wheel comprises a silicon steel alloy.
 16. The mouse of claim 15 wherein the magnet comprises a Halbach magnet.
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